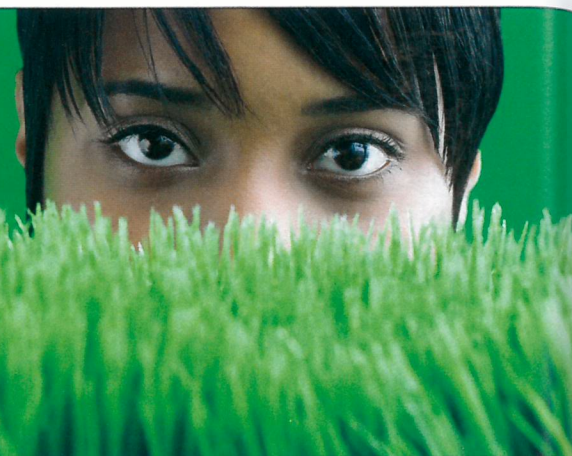




Green chic



Zero and first conditionals

Listening: Eco-revolution 1

1 Read about how three major companies are going 'green'. Do you know any organizations that have taken similar initiatives? Think of two other green initiatives.

British Telecom fuelled by renewable energies

Cisco's videoconferencing plan saves carbon emissions

Japanese Giant Sanyo recycles 99.8% waste

2 Match these verbs and nouns. Then make sentences using these verb and noun combinations.

- | | |
|-----------|------------------------------------|
| 1 reduce | a paper and envelopes |
| 2 replace | b a recycling scheme |
| 3 reuse | c light bulbs with low-energy ones |
| 4 drive | d energy costs |
| 5 launch | e fuel-efficient cars |

3 2.7 Listen to part one of a radio programme about green business. Tick (✓) the initiatives that are mentioned in exercise 2. What other ideas do you hear?

4 Listen to part one of the programme again and correct this advice to companies about going green. There are nine errors.

- If you exchange your old light bulbs with low-energy ones, it can increase your electricity bills.
- Switch to less fuel-efficient cars if you have a fleet of company buses.
- If you drive a recycling scheme, it probably won't save you time, but it will help to replace your employees.
- Unless you have a lot of time and energy, it makes sense to start with these big initiatives.

Grammar: Zero and first conditionals

5 Read the information in the table and complete the sentences.

Zero conditional

If + present simple, present simple.
 It is possible to change the order of the clauses.

- If he _____ (leave) the office, he _____ (switch off) the light.
- _____ (switch off) the light if you _____ (leave) the office.

We can use **unless**, **when** or **whenever** instead of **if** in the main clause.

- When/Whenever she _____ (leave) a room, she _____ (switch off) the lights.
- Unless you _____ (have) a lot of time and money, it _____ (make) sense to start with simple initiatives.

We use the zero conditional to talk about situations and events that are generally true.

6 Complete these company guidelines to staff about going green. Put the verbs in the correct form using the zero conditional.

be save clean turn not print use pay help

Eco Guidelines

- You save trees when you _____ recycled paper.
- You reduce the use of paper if you _____ emails and documents.
- Every time you _____ down the thermostat, you cut down on electricity consumption and carbon emissions.
- When you car share with colleagues, you _____ yourself money and _____ to protect the environment.
- If there _____ plants in your office, they _____ the air and provide more oxygen.
- If you _____ attention to the small things, it is easy to have a greener, more pleasant office.

7 Read the information in the table and complete the sentences.

First conditional

If + present tense, will + base form (or an imperative). It is possible to change the order of the clauses.

- We use the first conditional to talk about real possibilities now and in the future.
 If we _____ (use) recycled paper, it _____ (be) more eco-friendly.
- We use **unless** to mean 'if not'.
 Air quality _____ (get) worse **unless** we _____ (reduce) carbon emissions.
- We can use other modal verbs such as *may*, *might*, *must*, *have to*, *can*, *should* instead of *will* in the first conditional.
 You _____ (save) money **if** you _____ (turn) the heating down a bit.

>> For more information on the zero and first conditionals, see page 169.

8 Complete these sentences using the first conditional.

- If I _____ (have) time later, I _____ (take) these newspapers to the recycling bin.
- He _____ (help) you if you _____ (not understand) anything in the guidelines.
- If we _____ (not turn down) the heating, our bill _____ (be) enormous this month.
- Our client _____ (go) to another supplier if we _____ (not implement) a green energy policy.
- They _____ (not be) very happy if they _____ (not get) that new contract.
- People _____ (not buy) more of our products unless we _____ (reduce) the prices.

Listening: Eco-revolution 2

9 2.8 Listen to part two of the radio programme and complete the journalist's notes.

One major corporation that is introducing more innovative green projects is 1 _____.
 The company have installed 2 _____ solar panels on the rooftops of their headquarters.
 These panels can provide 3 _____% of the company's electricity at peak times. The investment will pay for itself in 4 _____ and then they'll have cheap electricity for many years.
 The company makes donations to charity if staff 5 _____, _____ or _____ to work. It also provides a 6 _____ service for staff. And if they must use their cars, they get cash incentives to 7 _____.
 PB Copy is a small 8 _____ company in Canada. They use an 9 _____ to power their equipment. Customers can help by 10 _____ while they're waiting for their copies.

10 Look at the audio script on page 152 and find three more examples of conditional sentences.

TALKING POINT Has your place of work/study gone green? How? Why?

Speaking: Bright ideas

11 Work in groups. Look at the ideas in exercise 6 again.

- Brainstorm more ideas for reducing an organization's impact on the environment.
- Rank your ideas in order of importance.
- Prepare a five-point proposal to present to another group.
- Give reasons why your ideas will be effective.

